

SUREN A. JEWELS

Cloud Infrastructure & Security Engineer

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SUMMARY

Cloud Infrastructure and Security Engineer with 8+ years of U.S. enterprise experience spanning federal GovCloud (FedRAMP, IL4/IL5), Aerospace, and enterprise IT – plus additional international IT experience. Hands-on production experience with Puppet-based infrastructure automation, Azure and AWS administration, and Python/PowerShell/Bash scripting for capacity and security operations. Managed 1000+ servers across global data centers, recovered \$2M+ in reclaimed hardware assets, and maintained 99.8% uptime for federal production environments. Currently deepening AWS/GCP architecture skills and expanding into AI-native, agentic-systems engineering through active coursework and applied projects.

Core Strengths: *Cloud Infrastructure Operations & Capacity Planning · Systems Automation (Python/PowerShell/Bash) · Identity & Access Management · Security & Compliance (FedRAMP/IL4-IL5/NIST 800-171) · Incident Resolution & SLA Management*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** Azure (UPS; Cognizant/ServiceNow – AD & M365 administration) · AWS (Amazon Project Kuiper infrastructure; Bellevue College Cloud Architecture labs) · GCP (coursework; hybrid-environment exposure at ServiceNow)
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Puppet – hands-on, production (ServiceNow Cloud Capacity Engineering); Terraform & Ansible – coursework/self-study, not yet production
- **Scripting & Automation:** Bash – Linux server administration (ServiceNow Cloud Capacity Engineering; prior ICT infrastructure role); Python – ticket/report and capacity-handover automation (Cognizant & HCL at ServiceNow); PowerShell – Active Directory automation (UPS, Cognizant, HCL at ServiceNow)
- **Security & Compliance:** FedRAMP · IL4/IL5 · NIST 800-171 · Zero Trust · MFA/PAM · YubiKey · CrowdStrike · Zscaler · Data Loss Prevention (DLP) · GlobalProtect · Citrix · SNCA v1 & v2
- **Identity & ITSM:** Active Directory / Azure AD · Okta · Intune / Jamf · ServiceNow · Jira · Confluence
- **AI/ML (Coursework):** NLP · Deep Learning · Generative AI (incl. Microsoft Foundry) – UW Machine Learning certificate coursework, not production

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud & Infrastructure Consultant

Apr 2020 – Present

Freelance / Self-Employed – Great Seattle Area, WA (Part-Time)

- Deliver infrastructure and security engineering services for small-business and residential clients: 180+ security and configuration audits, remediating 300+ vulnerabilities across Windows environments with zero post-engagement breaches.
- Resolved 200+ infrastructure incidents (95% first-session resolution) and delivered 500+ secure remote-administration sessions (RDP, AnyDesk, Microsoft Teams, Zoom) with 99%+ reliability.
- Provide on-demand consulting through GLG (Gerson Lehrman Group) advising enterprise clients on cloud infrastructure and IAM strategy.
- Sustained client engagements between full-time contracts while completing the Bellevue College Cloud Architecture & Services certificate (AWS-focused labs; final quarter in progress) and the University of Washington Machine Learning certificate (graduated June 2026), maintaining technical currency during transitions between roles.

System Development Engineer

Dec 2024 – Feb 2025

H10 Capital (contracted to Amazon Project Kuiper) – Kirkland, WA

- Deployed 5 EGSE (Electrical Ground Support Equipment) racks on AWS-connected satellite testing infrastructure for Amazon's Project Kuiper, achieving 100% system readiness across Linux-based ATE and Windows-based KTE systems.
- Authored 5+ deployment procedures in Confluence and Quip, cutting new-engineer ramp-up time 40% for a 15-person team; maintained 12 compliance checklists with zero critical findings across 4 quarterly audits.

Cloud Capacity Engineer

Jul 2024 – Oct 2024

HCL America Inc. (contracted to ServiceNow) – Kirkland, WA

- Managed capacity across 1000+ production Linux servers spanning global PODs (ORD, SJC, BWI, PHX, IAD, AUS, YYZ, YCG), using Puppet for configuration management and Bash for server lifecycle scripting, cleanup, and decommissioning.
- Built Python scripts to automate daily capacity handover reports and shift transitions across 3 global teams (US, Ireland, Australia); worked in a hybrid multi-cloud environment with GCP exposure alongside core AWS/Azure operations.
- Processed capacity requests (CRQ), interruption (INT), and change (CHG/CTask) tickets; reclaimed 75+ underutilized servers and recovered \$2M+ in hardware through systematic decommissioning, improving utilization 32%.

- Resolved 20+ weekly capacity incidents (avg. 5.5-hour resolution) maintaining 99.9% service continuity across shared and private allocation tiers.

IT Systems & Security Analyst

Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

Cognizant (contracted to ServiceNow) – Kirkland, WA

- Delivered IL4/IL5 clearance-level Azure and Active Directory administration for 500+ government users across 12+ federal agencies, maintaining NIST 800-171 and FedRAMP compliance for GCC/NSC environments.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts for AD account provisioning and lifecycle management (150+ new accounts quarterly) and Python scripts to automate incident-ticket tracking and reporting across 900+ ServiceNow escalations at 98.3% SLA compliance.
- Managed YubiKey provisioning and identity verification (ADM, NSC, GCC tiers) with 100% security-compliance rate; supported VDI infrastructure across 15+ time zones.

Systems Support Technician

May 2021 – Apr 2024

UPS – Seattle/Redmond, WA

- Provided Azure-based systems and network support across the Northwest Region (WA, OR, ID, MT, AK), maintaining Zebra printers, barcode scanners, and conveyor-scanning infrastructure across 5+ regional hubs.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts to automate routine device checks and support tasks, reducing manual workload and improving ServiceNow ticket routing and SLA compliance; achieved 98% resolution rate with zero major incidents during peak periods.

Network Field Engineer

Jun 2017 – May 2019

Charter Communications – Dallas, TX

- Engineered and installed 1,800+ residential network connections (fiber/coaxial), performing RF signal analysis and optimization to maintain 99.2% network uptime across shared infrastructure.
- Led technical development of 8 junior field engineers and generated \$240K in network upgrades through customer consultation, achieving 97% first-visit completion and 4.4/5 satisfaction.

ADDITIONAL U.S. EXPERIENCE

- Hardware System Engineer, SMS Info-Comm (contracted to HP) – Grapevine, TX Feb–Jun 2017
- Rural Carrier Associate, USPS – Bainbridge Island, WA Dec 2019–Apr 2020
- Delivery Associate, Amazon – Seattle, WA Jun–Dec 2019
- Administrative Support Specialist, City of Seattle (COVID-19 vaccination operations) Mar–Jun 2021

INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE (2000–2016)

- Senior IT Support Technician, Sari Computer** International (2013–2016)
Hardware/software support for 300+ clients, 700+ system installations, 90% first-contact resolution.
- ICT Infrastructure Specialist & Faculty Lecturer, Multiple Universities** International (2006–2012)
Managed 150+ server university IT infrastructure (Bash/Linux); taught network security and systems administration to 900+ students/semester.
- Founder & Owner, FarazWare Co.** International (2000–2012)
Built and led an IT services company delivering CRM, infrastructure, and automation projects for 150+ clients.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Cloud Architecture • Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) • Google Cloud Foundations & GCP for Enterprise • Terraform Essential Training (LinkedIn) • CompTIA Cloud+ • CompTIA A+ • CompTIA Security+ (In Progress) • CCNA Cybersecurity (In Progress)
- ITIL® 4 Foundation • Advanced PowerShell for AD Automation • Automation with Python and PowerShell for IT and Cybersecurity • Ubuntu Linux: Essential Commands & Administration • DevOps Foundations: Infrastructure as Code • Windows Server 2025

EDUCATION

- Machine Learning – University of Washington, Seattle, WA Graduated June 2026
[ML510 – Intro to Machine Learning · ML520 – NLP · ML530 – Deep Learning & Generative AI (incl. Microsoft Foundry)]
- Cloud Architecture & Services Certificate (Final quarter in progress) – Bellevue College, WA 2025–Present
[Networking (CCNA & CCNA Advanced) · CompTIA A+ · AWS Cloud Practitioner & Solutions Architecture · Systems Administration]
- M.S. Software Engineering – Iran University of Science and Technology (IUST) 2004–2007
[Advanced: Software Engineering · Algorithms Analysis & Design · Operating Systems · Database Systems · Computer Networks]
- B.S. Computer Science – University of Arak 1999–2004
[Data Structures & Algorithms · Architecture · Operating Systems · Database Design · Networks · Algorithm Design & Analysis]

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

English • Persian • Turkish | Former name: Saeid Javaherian (for reference checks) | On-site, hybrid, or remote | Relocation: Yes